

Spelling — Suffixes -ful, -less, -ness

Year 3 · -ful, -less, -ness

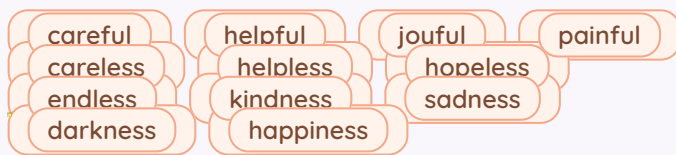
ACARA V9.0 — AC9E3LY09, AC9E3LY10 (Phonic and word knowledge: less common letter patterns and generalisations for spelling)

Learning Intention: Students will identify, spell, and use words featuring **-ful**, **-less**, **-ness**, and apply a strategy for remembering tricky spellings.

Pattern Focus

The suffix **-ful** means ‘full of’, **-less** means ‘without’, and **-ness** turns a describing word into a naming word. The spelling of the base word usually doesn’t change.

This Week’s Words (12)



Write Each Word

careful	helpful
joyful	painful
careless	helpless
hopeless	endless
kindness	sadness
darkness	happiness

Sort the Words

Word bank: careful, careless, darkness, endless, happiness, helpful, helpless, hopeless, joyful, kindness, painful, sadness

-ful

-less

-ness

Find & Fix

Circle the misspelled word, then write it correctly:

carefull →

helpfull →

carless →

hopless →

kindnes →

sadnes →

Dictation Sentences (read aloud, student writes)

1. Be careful and helpful. 2. It was a painful, endless day. 3. Her kindness brought happiness. 4. Sadness turned to joyful laughter. 5. Darkness felt hopeless at first.

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Proofread the Paragraph

Find and circle 5 spelling mistakes, then write the paragraph correctly on the lines below:

Be carefull and helpfull. It was a painfull, endles day. Her kindnes brought happiness.

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Extension — Write Your Own

Pick 3 words from this set and write your own sentences:

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Complete the Sentence

Word bank: careful, helpful, kindness, happiness, endless

- Please be with the glass.
- Thank you for being so
- Her made everyone smile.
- True comes from within.
- The list felt

Assessment — Spelling Test

Say each word, have the student write it, then check together:

careful helpful careless kindness sadness happiness

Bonus Sentence: Her kindness and helpfulness brought true happiness.

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Score: / 6

Next Steps: ☐ Ready for next pattern ☐ Needs more practice with this pattern ☐ Revisit in 2 weeks

Word Search

S	S	C	P	M	X	H	E	C	S
S	S	J	A	A	Z	A	A	S	E
E	E	O	T	R	I	R	E	N	R
L	N	Y	C	G	E	N	D	A	K
E	K	F	Y	F	I	L	F	R	T
P	R	U	U	P	E	L	E	U	N
O	A	L	P	S	G	I	X	S	L
H	D	A	S	F	C	B	Y	I	S
O	H	K	I	N	D	N	E	S	S
C	G	S	S	E	L	P	L	E	H

Find all 12 words in the grid:

careful helpful joyful painful careless

helpless hopeless endless kindness

sadness darkness happiness

Parent/Teacher Tip: Point out that -ful has only one l, even though it sounds like it could have two — it's one of the most common spelling mistakes at this age.

For teachers and parents: use this page to check student responses across both worksheet pages.

Sort the Words

- ful:** careful, helpful, joyful, painful
- less:** careless, helpless, hopeless, endless
- ness:** kindness, sadness, darkness, happiness

Find & Fix

- carefull → careful helpfull → helpful carless → careless
- hopless → hopeless kindnes → kindness
- sadnes → sadness

Complete the Sentence

- careful
- helpful
- kindness
- happiness
- endless

Spelling Test Words

careful, helpful, careless, kindness, sadness, happiness

Bonus: Her kindness and helpfulness brought true happiness.

Proofread the Paragraph — Corrected Version

Be careful and helpful. It was a painful, endless day. Her kindness brought happiness.

Dictation Sentences — Reference Spelling

- Be careful and helpful.
- It was a painful, endless day.
- Her kindness brought happiness.
- Sadness turned to joyful laughter.
- Darkness felt hopeless at first.

Word Search — All 12 Words

careful, helpful, joyful, painful, careless, helpless, hopeless, endless, kindness, sadness, darkness, happiness — placed horizontally, vertically, and diagonally throughout the grid.